

Chapter 149_2 - Revenge

Chu Qingqiu stood at the edge of the cliff. Her gaze swept over the refreshed mountains and rivers, over the ghost fire that had disappeared and could no longer pose a threat, and finally settled on the jade-green vase body.

The vase sat quietly in her hand, but Chu Qingqiu's ears echoed with clear calls of "Master."

From the little milk dumpling only as big as a forearm, to the later spirited young girl, to the bird she willingly transformed into—she had always stayed by her master's side, never leaving for even half a step.

Even now, it was the same.

"Penglai." Chu Qingqiu suddenly spoke. She gripped the vase in her palm. "Ning Fuyi!"

Ning Fuyi hurried forward. Her hand was suddenly gripped tightly, and looking down, she met those peach blossom eyes that were holding back tears and were filled with bloodshot veins from the strain.

Looking at those eyes, Ning Fuyi felt a mixture of emotions.

She admitted that when she woke up to see Chu Qingqiu safe and sound, she had felt complete relief. But now that Chu Qingqiu didn't have to die, she couldn't be happy.

Because she knew that if Qiu Yi hadn't died in Chu Qingqiu's place, then she herself should have already gone mad by now.

"I'll listen to everything you say," Ning Fuyi said.

A few more tears fell from Chu Qingqiu's eyes, but she quickly turned and let the tears scatter in the wind. Her tall figure passed through the dispersing crowd, striding toward Cloud Deep Hall.

Ning Fuyi knew that Chu Qingqiu was going to fight against Penglai regardless of everything.

The crowd also dispersed following Chu Qingqiu. Ning Fuyi lowered her head and silently collected the two curved blades that Qiu Yi had left behind. She wiped the blood clean and carefully placed them in her thought pearl¹.

As she turned to follow the crowd, she saw the red figure still standing in place.

The usually charming and unrestrained body was now very rigid, as if frozen in place. Ning Fuyi felt pity and slowly walked to her front.

"What's wrong with you?" Ning Fuyi said softly.

"I don't know." Jiuying answered. She still looked at the bloodstains on the ground that hadn't been completely washed away, her golden pupils filled with confusion and bewilderment.

"Last night, besides about the jade vase, did she say nothing else?" Ning Fuyi couldn't help asking.

"There was also her background, about Cangyun Kingdom—how Penglai slaughtered her entire country to seize the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase."

Ning Fuyi nodded in surprise and asked again, "What else?"

"She asked me if I hated her." Jiuying lowered her fan-like eyelashes. "Nothing else besides that."

Ning Fuyi felt a sourness in her heart, including her eye sockets. She opened her mouth several times wanting to say something, but looking at Jiuying's expression, she couldn't say anything.

"So do you hate her?"

Jiuying shook her head, her red lips curving into a bitter smile. She looked at Ning Fuyi powerlessly: "This wasn't the first time she died in front of me, but although I felt pity before, that pity was ultimately condescending."

"But now, I don't know why, here..." She tapped her heart with her bright red fingernails. "It feels stuffy."

Ning Fuyi looked up at the sky, holding back tears, then opened her arms and pulled the confused woman into her embrace.

When the other person rested on her shoulder, she gently patted her back and said, "It's better that you don't know."

As she patted, her neck sensitively detected a teardrop.

"I'm going to find the Divine Venerable," Ning Fuyi sniffed and said.

Jiuying told Chu Qingqiu everything Qiu Yi had said word for word. After hearing it, Chu Qingqiu only became more silent, then gripped the white bone even tighter.

She had long known that the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase had fallen into the mortal world, so in order to find this magical artifact, she had made efforts for a while.

She indeed knew that the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase might be related to Qiu Yi. Being able to find and adopt Qiu Yi in the first place was also because she was searching for the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase. But she never knew that the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase she sought but couldn't find was actually parasitic within Qiu Yi's soul.

Now that the ghost fire no longer posed a threat, all sects also regained their morale and assembled immortal armies, preparing to attack Penglai soon to completely eliminate its arrogance and restore peace to the six realms.

The immortal realm battle was about to break out. Tension filled the air everywhere. Because of the ghost fire incident, countless immortal sect members completely shattered their reverence for Penglai and turned to complete disgust.

There were even more radical ones who couldn't wait to rush to Penglai's gates right now and beat them into a mess.

For several days, Chu Qingqiu had been in Cloud Deep Hall, discussing strategies with sect leaders from various schools. Ning Fuyi didn't participate but moved a rattan chair to sit outside Cloud Deep Hall, silently accompanying Chu Qingqiu.

In everyone's eyes, she seemed to do nothing and say nothing, so no one paid her any attention.

Finally, the doors of Cloud Deep Hall opened. The sect leaders and elders walked out in groups of two or three, each looking hurried as they left Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate, rushing back to their sects to deploy.

Even Li Hanhan, who usually didn't get along with Ning Fuyi, didn't look at her but lifted her skirt and hurried past, stepping on clouds and flying away.

When most people had left, Ning Fuyi entered the hall. Elder Pingyao, who had been saying something to Chu Qingqiu, saw her come and coughed twice, found an excuse, and left with vigorous steps.

Chu Qingqiu didn't normally need to eat, but after being confined in the hall for several days, she visibly looked thinner. Ning Fuyi felt heartache and stepped forward, embracing her waist from behind.

"Have you decided?" Ning Fuyi asked.

Chu Qingqiu nodded. Her body leaned to one side, naturally lying on Ning Fuyi's shoulder, closing her eyes to rest.

She wanted to avenge Qiu Yi, and all those lives that Penglai had wantonly slaughtered.

There were dark circles under the immortal's eyes. Ning Fuyi stared at her profile for a long time, then held her tighter: "That Tianrui Emperor Lord is truly cunning. We must be careful, and besides, you..."

"Now that I have the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase and my immortal power has recovered by twenty percent, don't worry," Chu Qingqiu said consolingly.

"I'm not worried." Ning Fuyi lowered her head to kiss her hair. "I will protect you."

Hearing this, Chu Qingqiu's lips curved slightly, taking it as her passionate enthusiasm.

Ning Fuyi felt her smile, so she made her voice heavier: "I really will protect you!"

Then she pushed her away, looked into her eyes, and said with certainty: "I want to tell you a secret."

"What secret?" Chu Qingqiu looked up warily.

"First say you won't be angry, otherwise how would I dare tell you?" Ning Fuyi said while reaching to tickle her waist. Chu Qingqiu immediately twisted in her arms like a flower branch.

"Ning Fuyi!" Chu Qingqiu ultimately couldn't resist her unreasonable behavior. Her face, which had been clouded for several days, finally showed some laughter, then she restrained her smile.

"Fine, fine, fine, I agree. Tell me, what secret?"

Footnotes:

1. **Thought Pearl (一念珠)** - A storage artifact that can hold items within a small space, accessed through the user's thoughts.